

The 6 Metrics Every Private Lender Should Track Monthly

Most lenders track volume. The best ones track what drives it.

Deal velocity (days from application to close)

Volume tells you how many deals closed. Velocity tells you whether your process is getting faster or slower. Declining velocity is an early warning signal — not a closing-table problem.

Quote-to-close conversion rate

What percentage of quotes become closed loans? If this is declining, the cause is usually pricing inconsistency, delayed response times, or a term sheet that doesn't match the quote.

Stated margin vs. realized margin

Your stated margin is what the guidelines say. Realized margin is what actually closed. The gap — driven by LO discretion, broker negotiation, and exceptions — is real money, usually invisible without intentional tracking.

Repeat borrower rate

What share of closed loans in a given month are from borrowers who've closed with you before? This is the most honest retention metric — not follows, not testimonials. Repeat loans.

Exception frequency + LO pricing variance

How often do deals go outside standard guidelines? And how much do individual LOs' closing rates vary on similar deal profiles? These two numbers tell you where the system has gaps.

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